Vanitha Virudachalam

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Positions Held

Gies College of Business, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

2020-Present	Assistant Professor of Business Administration (tenure-track) Medical leave from Nov 2021 to April 2022
2021-2022	RC Evans Data Analytics Scholar, University of Illinois-Deloitte Foundation Center for Business Analytics
2019-2020	Instructor of Business Administration

Education

2020	PhD	*The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania* Operations Management
2012	MPP	*University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy* Public Policy, with Honors
2006	BA	*University of California, Berkeley* Applied Mathematics, emphasis in Operations Research High distinction in general scholarship

Refereed Publications

1. Kaaua, D. and **Virudachalam, V.** (2025) Going the Distance: The Impact of Commute on Gender Diversity in Public Service. *Manufacturing & Service Operations Managemen*t, 27(2), 607-623. (link, SSRN)

2. **Virudachalam, V.**, Savin, S., Steinberg, M. (2024). Too Much Information: When Does Additional Testing Benefit Schools? *Management Science*, 70(9), 6220-6233. (link)

3. Bavafa, H., Örmeci, L., Savin, S., **Virudachalam, V**. (2021). Surgical Case-Mix and Discharge Decisions: Does Within-Hospital Coordination Matter? *Operations Research*, 70(2), 990-1007. (link)

Additional Publications

4. Tomljanovic, S., Gopalakrishnan, S., Kiddell-Monroe, R. and **Virudachalam, V**. (2025). How to Finance Community-Led Solutions. *Stanford Social Innovation Review*, *23*(4), 48–57. https://doi.org/10.48558/08EH-C393

Honors & Awards

2025	Dept. of Business Administration Research Excellence Award ($5,000)
2024	Gies Grant ($8,960)

Updated April 27, 2026

2023 (2x), 2021	Teachers Ranked as Excellent
2021	Junior Faculty Council Grant ($3,750)
2017	Russell Ackoff Doctoral Student Fellowship ($1,000)
2013–2019	Wharton Doctoral Fellowship
2010–2012	Dean's Scholarship (Full tuition scholarship), University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy
2006	Phi Beta Kappa
2002–2006	Regents' & Chancellor's Scholar, University of California, Berkeley

Invited Seminars

2022	Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University
2019	Tuck School of Business, Dartmouth College
2018	Gies School of Business, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Conference Presentations

2026	POMS Annual Meeting *(scheduled),* INFORMS Annual Meeting *(scheduled)*
2025	Utah Winter Operations Conference, POMS Annual Meeting, INFORMS Annual Meeting
2024	INFORMS Annual Meeting
2023	Early-Career Sustainable Operations Management Workshop, INFORMS Annual Meeting
2022	INFORMS Annual Meeting*
2021	POMS Annual Meeting, INFORMS Healthcare
2020	INFORMS Annual Meeting
2019	POMS Annual Meeting, INFORMS Healthcare, INFORMS Annual Meeting
2018	POMS Annual Meeting, MSOM Conference, YinzOR Student Conference, INFORMS Annual Meeting
2017	INFORMS Annual Meeting
2016	Wharton-INSEAD Consortium

*Coauthor presented due to scheduling conflict

Teaching Experience

Gies College of Business, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

- BADM 211: Business Analytics II (Undergraduate Core): Spring 2020, Spring 2021, Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025

Service

Professional Service

- Refereeing for Journals
  Management Science, *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management*, *POMS, INFORMS Transactions on Education, Operations Research*
- Refereeing/Judging for Conferences and Competitions
  Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference (2021), Public Sector OR Best Paper Competition (2022), Public Sector OR Best Paper Competition (2022), MSOM

Conference (2023, 2025), MSOM Conference Sustainable Operations SIG (2024, 2026), Elwood S. Buffa Doctoral Dissertation Competition at Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference (2026)

- Conference Session Chair
  INFORMS Healthcare (2019), INFORMS (2022-2026), POMS (2025)
- *Doing Good with Good OR Student Paper Competition* Committee Member (2024-2026), Chair (2025)

Academic Service

Gies College of Business, IOSA

2026	BADM 211 Redesign Committee *(Chair)*
2025-Present	Gies AI Curriculum Task Force
2025-Present	Committee for AI in Teaching
2024-Present	Supply Chain Management Conference Organizing Committee *(Member 2024-2025, Chair 2025-2027)*
2024-Present	BADM 211 Course Coordinator
2023	Tenure-track Faculty Recruitment Committee
2023	Specialized Faculty Recruitment Committee
2023	Teaching Assistant Professor Recruitment Committee
2022-2025	IOSA Seminar Organizer
2020-2023	PhD Recruitment Committee
2020, 2022-2024, 2026	PhD Admissions Committee

Professional Experience

2012-2013	Data Analyst, Springfield Public Schools, Springfield, MA
2008-2009	MyNewPlace, San Francisco, CA Marketing Manager (2008-2009), Data Analyst (2008)
2007-2008	Program Coordinator, The Synergos Institute, New York, NY